

Digital Literacy Project – Task 5

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Case Study: Phishing Attack

Phishing is a cybercrime where attackers impersonate trusted entities to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs. In a typical scenario, a student receives an email that appears to be from a bank or university. The email contains a link asking the user to verify their account urgently. When the victim clicks the link, they are redirected to a fake website that looks identical to the original. The victim unknowingly enters their credentials, which are then captured by the attacker. Students and young internet users are common targets due to limited awareness. The consequences can include financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorized access to personal accounts. In many cases, victims realize the fraud only after money is deducted or accounts are compromised, making recovery difficult.

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

- 1 Do not click on suspicious or unknown links
- 2 Always verify the sender's email address
- 3 Use strong and unique passwords for each account
- 4 Enable two-factor authentication (2FA)
- 5 Avoid using public Wi-Fi for financial transactions
- 6 Never share OTP, PIN, or passwords with anyone
- 7 Check UPI app notifications carefully before approving payments
- 8 Verify UPI requests before accepting collect/payment requests
- 9 Regularly monitor your bank account transactions
- 10 Report cybercrime at cybercrime.gov.in or call helpline 1930

Reflection

While researching cybercrime, I was surprised by how simple phishing attacks can be and how easily people fall for them due to urgency or fear. The fact that attackers can create websites and emails that look almost identical to real ones was particularly alarming. This made me realize the importance of verifying sources before taking any action online. As a result, I will adopt the habit of carefully checking URLs, avoiding unknown links, and never sharing sensitive information like OTPs. I will also educate my peers about safe online practices to prevent such incidents.